

2011 Cricket World Cup.

Page 1: Overview and Host Nations

The 2011 ICC Cricket World Cup was the tenth edition of the tournament. It was jointly hosted by three Asian nations: **India, Sri Lanka, and Bangladesh**. Originally, Pakistan was scheduled to be a co-host, but the ICC stripped them of their hosting rights following the 2009 attack on the Sri Lankan national team in Lahore.

- **Opening Ceremony:** Held on February 17, 2011, at the Bangabandhu National Stadium in Dhaka, Bangladesh.
- **Format:** 14 teams were divided into two groups of seven. The top four from each group advanced to the Quarter-finals.

Page 2: Participating Teams and Groupings

The tournament featured 10 full members and 4 associate members of the ICC.

- **Group A:** Australia, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, New Zealand, Zimbabwe, Canada, Kenya.
- **Group B:** India, South Africa, England, West Indies, Bangladesh, Ireland, Netherlands.
- **Key Associate Moment:** Ireland provided one of the biggest upsets in World Cup history by defeating England, thanks to Kevin O'Brien's record-breaking century in just 50 balls.

Page 3: India's Path - The Group Stages

India's journey was a rollercoaster of high-scoring games and narrow escapes.

1. **Opening Match:** India defeated Bangladesh by 87 runs (Sehwag scored 175).
2. **The Thriller vs. England:** The match ended in a rare **Tie**, with both teams scoring exactly 338 runs.
3. **The Sole Loss:** India lost to South Africa in a last-over thriller in Nagpur.
4. **Qualification:** India finished second in Group B with 9 points.

Page 4: Quarter-final Clash - India vs. Australia

Played at the Sardar Patel Stadium in Ahmedabad, this match ended Australia's 12-year reign as World Cup champions.

- **Australia's Score:** 260/6 (Ricky Ponting scored 104).
- **India's Chase:** Yuvraj Singh (57*) and Suresh Raina guided India to victory after a tense middle-over collapse.

- **Impact:** This win confirmed that a new world champion would be crowned for the first time since 1996.

Page 5: The High-Stakes Semi-final - India vs. Pakistan

Considered by many as the "Real Final," this match was played in Mohali and attended by the Prime Ministers of both nations.

- **India's Innings:** Sachin Tendulkar scored 85 (surviving several dropped catches). India finished at 260/9.
- **Pakistan's Chase:** India's five-man bowling attack (Zaheer, Munaf, Harbhajan, Nehra, Yuvraj) each took 2 wickets to bowl Pakistan out for 231.
- **Result:** India won by 29 runs.

Page 6: The Grand Final - Pre-Match Context

The final took place on **April 2, 2011**, at the Wankhede Stadium in Mumbai.

- **The Toss Controversy:** There was confusion over the call during the first toss, leading to a re-toss. Sri Lanka won and elected to bat.
- **Atmosphere:** The stadium was a sea of blue, with 33,000 spectators and over 135 million TV viewers in India alone.

Page 7: Sri Lanka's Innings

Sri Lanka posted a formidable total of **274/6**.

- **The Centurion:** Mahela Jayawardene played a classic innings, scoring 103* off 88 balls.
- **Late Surge:** Thisara Perera smashed 22 off just 9 balls at the end to set a challenging target for the hosts.
- **Indian Bowling:** Zaheer Khan started with three consecutive maiden overs and took 2 crucial wickets.

Page 8: India's Chase - The Early Shock

India's chase started disastrously against Lasith Malinga's pace.

- **Wicket 1:** Virender Sehwag out for a duck on the second ball (LBW).
- **Wicket 2:** Sachin Tendulkar caught behind for 18.
- **The Recovery:** Gautam Gambhir and a young Virat Kohli (35) stabilized the ship with an 83-run partnership before Kohli fell to a brilliant catch by Dilshan.

Page 9: The Captain's Gamble and the Finish

With the score at 114/3, MS Dhoni promoted himself above the in-form Yuvraj Singh.

- **The Logic:** Dhoni wanted to counter the Sri Lankan off-spinners (Muralitharan and Randiv) with a right-left batting combination alongside Gambhir.
- **The Partnership:** Dhoni and Gambhir added 109 runs. Gambhir fell for 97, just three runs short of a century.
- **The Final Blow:** With 4 runs needed, Dhoni hit an iconic six over long-on off Nuwan Kulasekara to win the match.

Page 10: Legacy and Statistics

India became the **first country to win the World Cup on home soil.**

- **Man of the Tournament:** Yuvraj Singh (362 runs and 15 wickets).
- **Man of the Match (Final):** MS Dhoni (91* off 79 balls).
- **Top Run-scorer:** Tillakaratne Dilshan (500 runs).
- **Top Wicket-takers:** Shahid Afridi and Zaheer Khan (21 wickets each).
- **Significance:** This was Sachin Tendulkar's sixth and final World Cup, finally achieving the one trophy that had eluded him for 22 years.